



“Oleg made inquiry of the wonder-working magicians as to the ultimate cause of his death.”

RUSSIAN PRIMARY CHRONICLE ON VOLKHYV, c. 1113

▲ **Animal magic**

Many animals had magical associations; the stag, for example, often represented speed, strength, or virility in spells. One 14th-century manuscript advised the use of a stag's testicles as an aphrodisiac.